

Exp no :08

Date :

Use Steg-Expose to Detect Hidden Data in Images

Description

StegExpose is a specialized tool used for **steganography analysis**. It works by evaluating the **statistical properties** of an image to estimate the probability of hidden data being embedded within it. This process helps forensic investigators detect steganography techniques like Least Significant Bit (LSB) embedding.

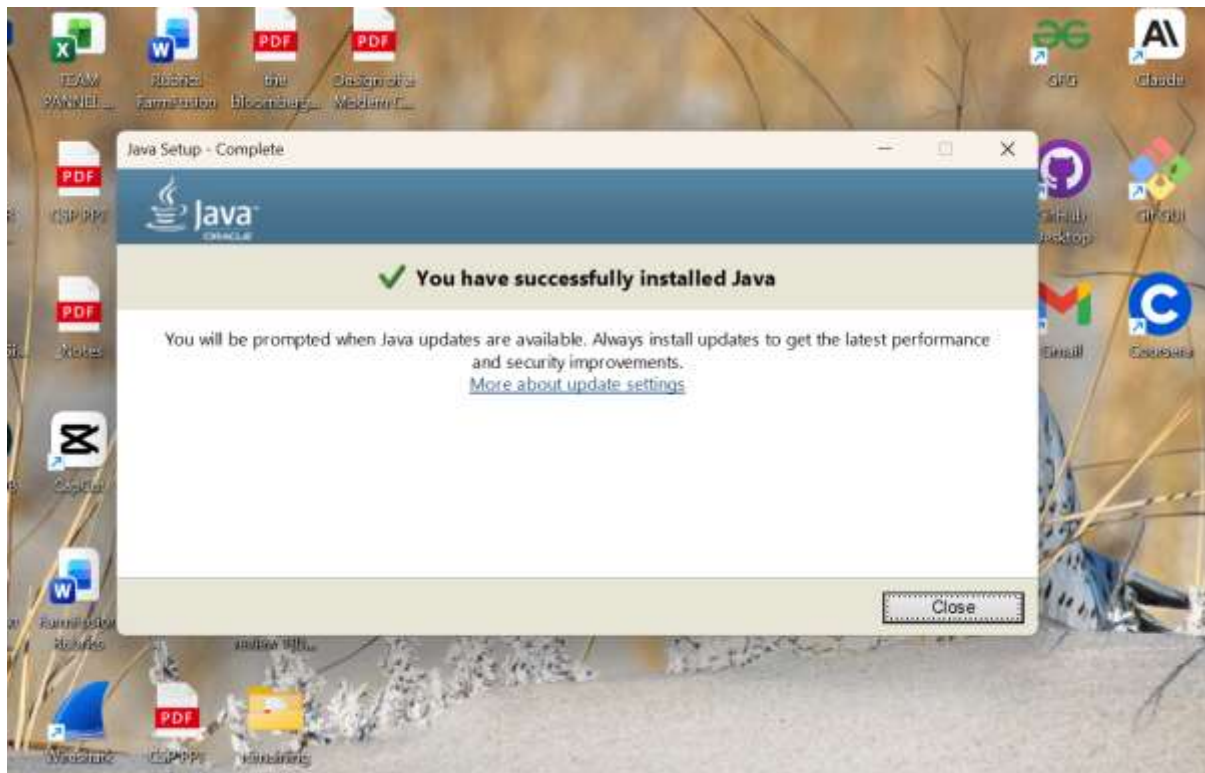
Prerequisites

- **Java Runtime Environment (JRE):** StegExpose is a Java-based application and requires JRE to run.
- **StegExpose Tool:** Download the latest .jar file from the official StegExpose GitHub repository.

Step-by-Step Process

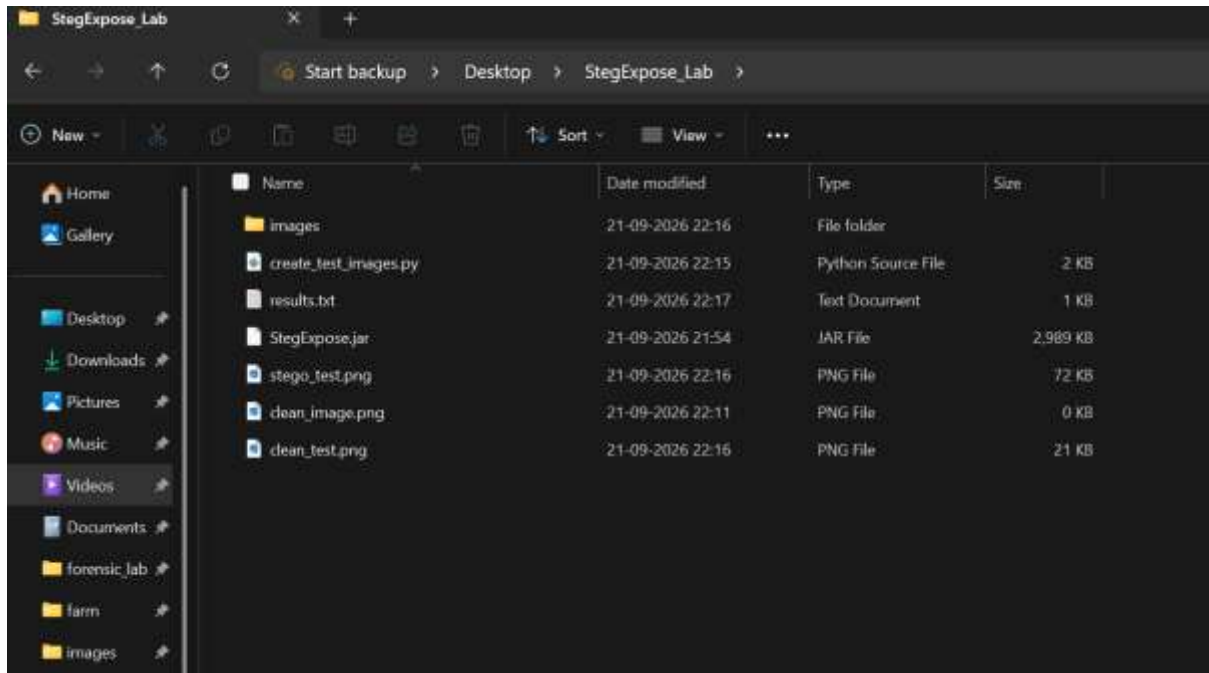
1. Download and Set Up StegExpose

1. **Download the tool:** Obtain the StegExpose.jar file from the GitHub repository.
2. **Install Java:** Ensure JRE is installed on your machine.
3. **Prepare environment:** Place the StegExpose.jar file in a dedicated working folder.



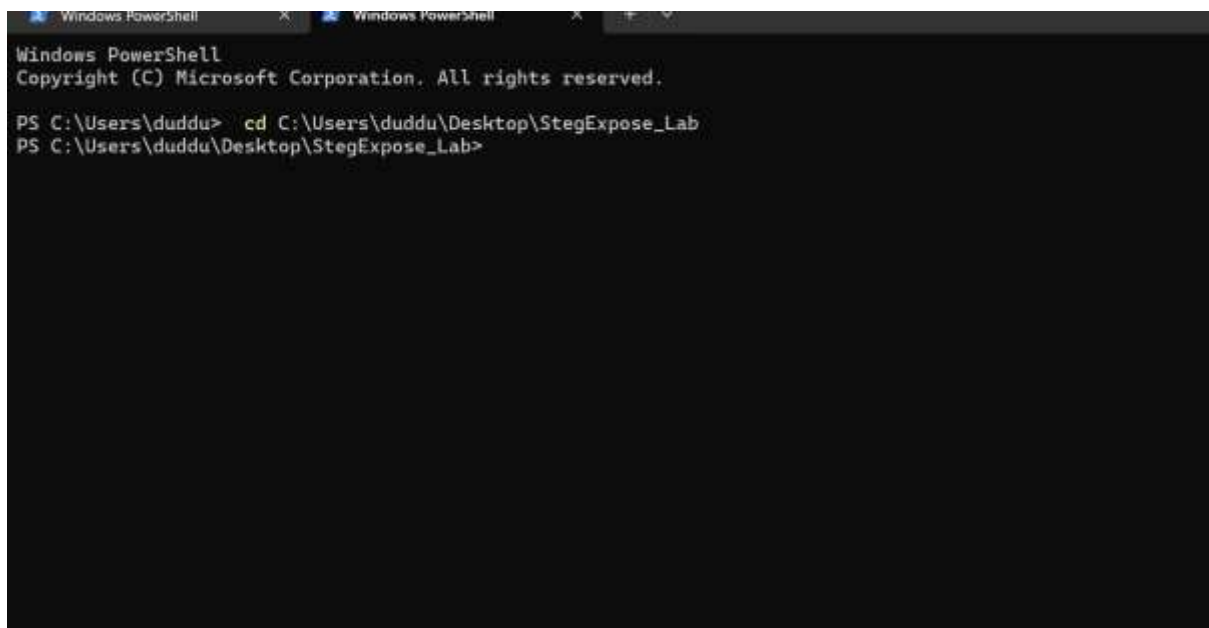
2. Select Images for Analysis

- Collect the images you suspect might contain hidden data.
- StegExpose supports common image formats such as .png, .jpg, and .bmp.



3. Open Command Line or Terminal

- Navigate to the folder where the StegExpose.jar file is located using your Command Prompt (Windows) or Terminal (Linux/macOS).



4. Run StegExpose on an Image

- Use the following command structure to analyze a single image for hidden data:

Command Structure:

```
java -jar StegExpose.jar <image_file_path>
```

Example:

```
java -jar StegExpose.jar test_image.png
```

5. Analyze the Output

- StegExpose calculates a **"suspect" score** ranging from 0 to 1. **The higher the score, the more likely steganography is present.**

Score Range	Interpretation (Suggested Thresholds)
Less than 0.2	Image is considered clean (no hidden data detected).
0.2 - 0.3	Possibly some hidden data is present.
Above 0.3	Likely that steganography is present.

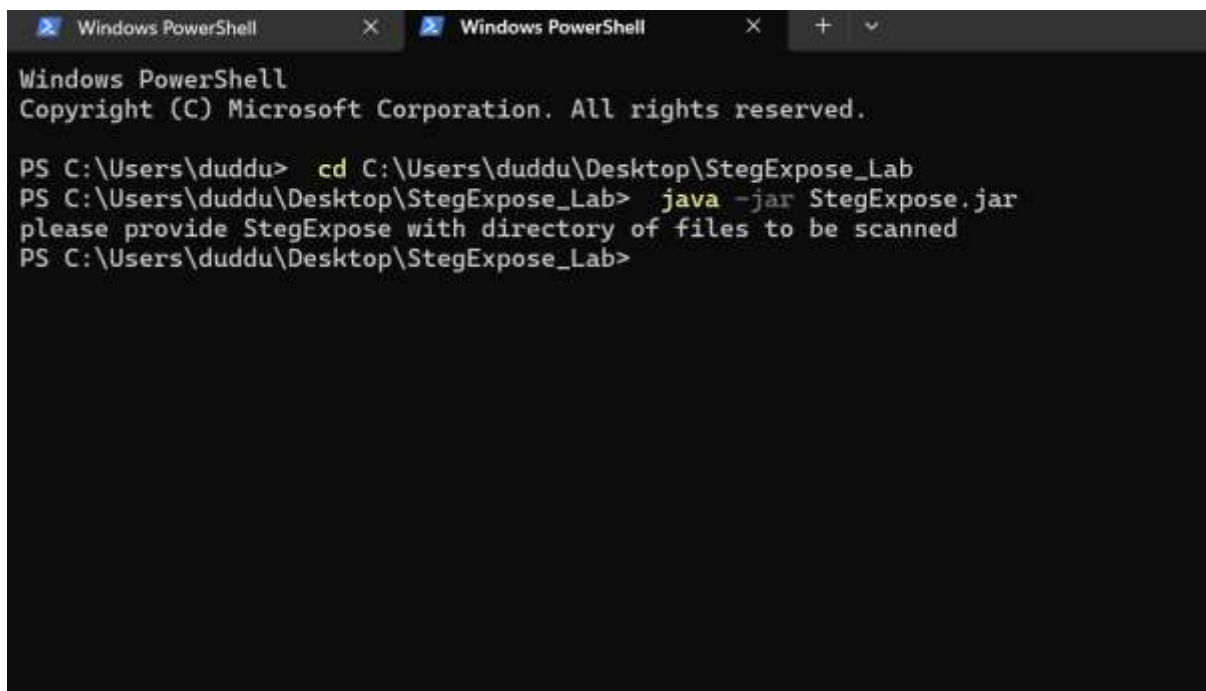
- **Example Output Analysis:**

```
java -jar StegExpose.jar suspect_image.png
```

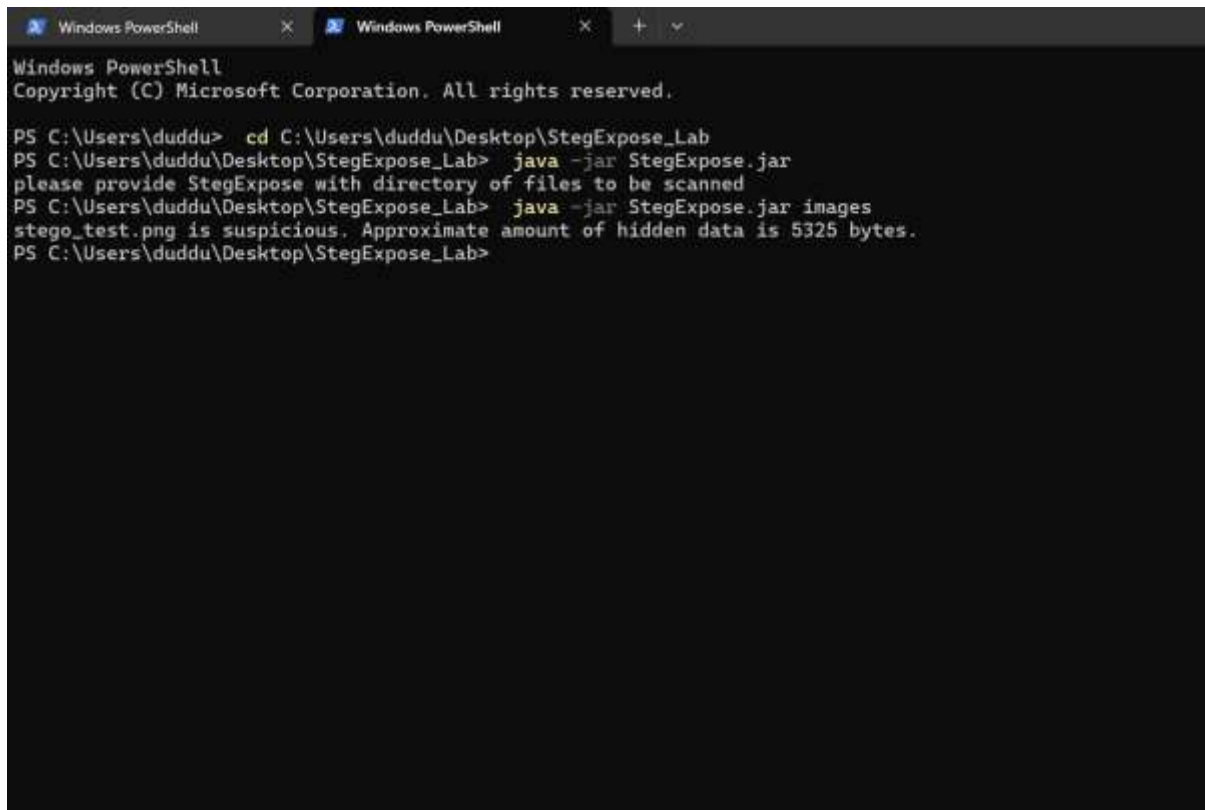
Analyzing suspect_image.png...

Result: 0.4

Steganography likely present

A screenshot of a Windows PowerShell terminal window. The title bar shows two instances of 'Windows PowerShell'. The terminal text is as follows:
Windows PowerShell
Copyright (C) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

PS C:\Users\duddu> cd C:\Users\duddu\Desktop\StegExpose_Lab
PS C:\Users\duddu\Desktop\StegExpose_Lab> java -jar StegExpose.jar
please provide StegExpose with directory of files to be scanned
PS C:\Users\duddu\Desktop\StegExpose_Lab>



```
Windows PowerShell
Copyright (C) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

PS C:\Users\duddu> cd C:\Users\duddu\Desktop\StegExpose_Lab
PS C:\Users\duddu\Desktop\StegExpose_Lab> java -jar StegExpose.jar
please provide StegExpose with directory of files to be scanned
PS C:\Users\duddu\Desktop\StegExpose_Lab> java -jar StegExpose.jar images
stego_test.png is suspicious. Approximate amount of hidden data is 5325 bytes.
PS C:\Users\duddu\Desktop\StegExpose_Lab>
```

6. Batch Analysis (Multiple Images)

- To check multiple images at once, specify the folder path containing the images:

Command Structure:

```
java -jar StegExpose.jar <folder_path>
```

7. Advanced Options (Optional)

- To view additional parameters, such as options for adjusting detection sensitivity or output verbosity, use the --help flag:

Command:

```
java -jar StegExpose.jar --help
```

8. Review the Results

- Review the scores generated for each image and use the threshold values to determine which images require further forensic investigation to extract the suspected hidden data.

Result:

The hidden data within the image was successfully detected using StegExpose. The analysis revealed that images with a suspect score above the threshold likely contain embedded steganographic content, confirming the tool's effectiveness in steganography detection.